

Toh 443 in the Kangyur is a tantric scripture known in Tibetan as the Gyud Chima

Toh 443 · Derge Kangyur

Toh 443 in the Kangyur is a tantric scripture known in Tibetan as the Gyud Chima, meaning "The Subsequent Tantra," and it belongs to the broader corpus of the Guhyasamāja cycle, functioning as a continuation or sequel tantra within that tradition. The text opens with an assembly of great bodhisattvas, led by Maitreya, who address all the Tathāgatas after having fully comprehended the empowerment and the secret teachings of the body, speech, and mind of all buddhas. It is a tantra of the Highest Yoga class concerned with the nature of vajra body, speech, and mind, the empowerments conferred by all Tathāgatas, and the essential purity of all sentient beings across the three times as expressed in verses of praise to Samantabhadra. The text was carefully edited and established as a definitive version by Dharma Lord Dpal, indicating a history of scholarly redaction within the Tibetan transmission. As Toh 443 in the Kangyur, it is classified among the tantras and represents an important companion text to one of the most influential cycles in Tibetan Vajrayāna literature.

Reverently requested and carefully edited by Dharma Lord Dpal, and established as a definitive text.

The Subsequent Tantra.

Then Maitreya and the other great bodhisattvas (Skt. bodhisattvas), having seen, heard, and fully understood all things exactly as they are and precisely in their proper sequence — concerning the empowerment bestowed by all the Tathāgatas and the teaching of the secret of their body, speech, and mind — spoke thus to all those Tathāgatas endowed with the vision of Dharma:

Oh! The body, speech, and mind of Samantabhadra are perfectly pure.

Through the three vajras, entirely,
he abides throughout the three vajras.

All sentient beings across the three times
have perfectly arisen as the essential nature of vajra.

The great miraculous display of buddha is vajra.

The state of awakening is attained as vajra.

Oh! This is supremely wondrous!

Oh! The peaceful one has transcended the senses.

Oh! The stream of the lord of the wheel of existence continues.

Oh! This is supreme nirvāṇa.

Then all those Tathāgatas declared to those great bodhisattvas:

So it is, bodhisattva.

So it is, great being.

Then all those great bodhisattvas gathered together once more, perfectly honored all those Tathāgatas with secret and outer offerings, made prostrations, and with a single voice spoke thus:

Oh! How supremely rare and wonderful!

This is the method for accomplishing awakening.

The supreme among the supreme tantras —
the tantra called Guhyasamāja.

In order to realize what is concealed,
and out of the wish to benefit sentient beings,
that which was taught through true speech —
we implore you, O Protector, to explain it.

Then all those Tathāgatas declared to those bodhisattvas:

These words of the concealed tantra —

wishing to ask all of them:

Well done, great being, well done!

Well done, O source of excellence, well done!

Then all the bodhisattvas,
with uplifted eyes filled with great joy,
prostrated again and again
and posed these questions with curiosity:

To what does "secret" refer?

To what does "assembled" refer?

What is the connection of the tantra?

What is the subject of this yoga tantra?

In how many aspects is suchness explained?

In how many aspects, likewise, is the secret?

To what does "great secret" refer?

How many aspects does the supreme have?

To what does "awakening mind" refer?

Likewise, what is the vidyā being?
To what does Vajradhṛk refer?
Likewise, what is Jinadhṛk?
And what is Ratnadhṛk?
Likewise, what is Ārolīka?
To what does Prajñādhṛk refer?
What is the family here, likewise?
To what does Moha refer?
To what does Dveṣa refer?
To what does Rāga refer?
To what does the vajra mantra refer?
To what does Rati refer here?
What is excellence?
What is the meaning of Yamāntakṛta?
Likewise, what is Prajñāntakṛta?
What is the name Padmāntakṛta?
Likewise, what is Vighnāntakṛta?
What is universal conduct?
Likewise, what is the conduct of mantra?
What is recitation here?
To what does "sealed" refer?
How does one meditate on the arising of phenomena?
Likewise, what is the nature of the vow?
What is the function of aversion, delusion, and attachment with regard to the Dharma?
How does one accomplish the benefit of sentient beings?
To what does "maṇḍala" refer?
How are the mudrās arranged?
What flowers are used here?
What is referred to as a stūpa?
What is the wisdom wheel?
What is referred to as knowing the place here?
How does one invoke the Protector?
And how does one dismiss?
How does one invite those beings?
What is binding here?
How is empowerment conferred?

Likewise, what is the vow of awareness?
How does one consume the five nectars?
Likewise, what are the five heroes?
What is an ordinary accomplishment like?
Likewise, what is the supreme like?
How many aspects does skillful means have?
Likewise, what is the arising of skillful means like?
How does one transmit the commands
of all vajra-holding yogins?
How do the various supreme assemblies
of action come about?

Then all those Tathāgatas, having listened closely to those words of inquiry put forward by those great bodhisattvas, directed their attention toward the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi and remained for a moment without saying anything.

Then the great bodhisattva,
supremely joyful, his very essence compassion,
urged the fully awakened buddhas, the Sugatas,
the Protectors, again and again.

Then all those Tathāgatas spoke thus to those bodhisattvas:

By the vajra of body, speech, and mind,
fix your attention upon the vajra of body, speech, and mind,
O lords of the awakening mind,
and listen closely to this vast inquiry.

Then all those great bodhisattvas received upon the crown of their heads the word thus spoken by all those Tathāgatas, and said: "Excellent! Excellent! O Blessed One. Excellent! Excellent! O Sugata." Then, through the vajra of their own body, speech, and mind, they directed their attention toward the vajra of body, speech, and mind of the great bodhisattva, the great Vajrapāṇi, and remained without uttering a word.

Then all those Tathāgatas, having blessed their own great mind-vajra and directed attention upon it, with a single voice declared to all those great bodhisattvas the answers to those inquiries:

Body, speech, and mind in their three aspects
are taught under the name "the secret."

What is called "all buddhas"
is explained as the assembled gathering.
The fifth, the ninth,
the seventeenth, and the thirteenth:
these, taught by buddhas and bodhisattvas,
constitute the great accomplishment.
The fourth and the sixteenth,
the eighth and likewise the twelfth:
these are the general activities of the master,
the vow of accomplishment and of the vow-conduct.
The sixth and the second,
the tenth and the fourteenth:
these are the vow of fierce conduct, of devotion,
and of proximate accomplishment.
The seventh and the third,
the eleventh and the fifteenth:
these are the vow of the field of accomplishment
and of approach and accomplishment with its signs.
The activity of all the Tathāgatas —
the deeds of cutting off, of benefiting, and of conduct —
is the entry of sentient beings who are tame,
difficult to tame, and pacified.
The four vajra rites of approach and accomplishment
connected with the generation stage
are related to the ordinary accomplishments;
the supreme text itself is the highest of all.
The text connected with the maṇḍala vow-conduct
is that of the fully excellent master.
Through the path of mantra, the guru
ripens disciples completely,
conferring the excellent vow-conduct and empowerment
upon one's own great disciples;
through buddhas and bodhisattvas,
liberation is brought about by the Teacher.
The entry of skillful means and wisdom into union
is what is called yoga.
That which knows the absence of inherent existence is wisdom;

skillful means has the characteristic of existence.

Tantra is known as "continuum,"

and that continuum takes three forms,
distinguished by ground, intrinsic nature,
and that which cannot be taken away.

The aspect of intrinsic nature is the cause;
likewise, that which cannot be taken away is the result.

The ground is what is called method and wisdom;
these three summarize the meaning of tantra.

The family is fivefold or threefold,
or of a single essential nature, or of a hundred families.

What is taught concerning awakening and vajra
is held to be the subsequent tantra.

That very thing is explained in five aspects;
the secret is explained in three aspects.

The remaining deity is the great secret,

The sacred family has a hundredfold form,
without beginning, without end, at peace.

The chief of what is exhausted in the substantial and the insubstantial,
emptiness and compassion inseparable —
this is what is called the awakening mind (bodhicitta).

Through the vajra of body, speech, and mind,
an essential nature that is indivisibly distinct,
endowed together with the family —
this is expressed as the person of awareness.

Five causes and five results:
this is what is taught as vajra.

Known as the one who holds and grasps,
consciousness is held to be the vajra-holder.
Vajradhrika is consciousness itself.

Transcending existence, non-existence, and the middle,
arising from elements, and from what has arisen from elements,
it is the body of all sentient beings.

From birth, the Victor, Jinajik —
since all aims arise from it,

mind is called the precious jewel.

Through the one who feels, by definite feeling,
feeling is held to be Ratnadhrika.

By way of the basis of characteristics, the defining mark, and the thing itself,
to all, by all, in all respects —
the defining mark and basis of joy
is said to be Ārolika.

That which brings consciousness to its ultimate completion
is wisdom (prajñā);
since it grasps formations and mental intention,
it is explained as Prajñādhrika.

Family is said to be tantra;
tantra is expressed as the primordial.
That which is fearless and free from birth —
that is explained to be the Protector.

Through aversion toward both cause and result,
consciousness is explained to be aversion.
By virtue of the inert and bound nature,
form is explained to be delusion.

By virtue of its identity as the conceit of selfhood,
feeling is explained to be pride.
Having the characteristic of clinging to things,
perception is precisely the identity of true clinging.
Having an identity drawn on by ornament,
formations are ever and always envy.

The essential nature of the awakening mind,
in all of saṃsāra, in all arising,
the mind possessed of attachment, aversion, and delusion —
this is explained as desire.

The samaya (Skt. samaya) resembles the manifold.
The fruit born from karma in its manifest direction —
toward the non-dual wisdom and phenomena,
acting in pride is explained as delusion.
Mutual chafing therein

is explained to be aversion.

The characteristic is fixation as desire.

Wisdom and skillful means are explained as vajra.

The supreme enjoyment of perfect bliss,
the woman of supreme bliss, excellent in every way,
abides ever in delight in the vajra
together with delusion, aversion, and desire.

Therefore the skillful means of the buddhas
is explained as the Vajra Vehicle.

The phenomena whose identity is indestructible
are of an unborn essential nature;
this is the samaya of all things,
and that same reality brings Yamāntaka to his end.

The phenomena that are not consciousness, not self,
are ultimately unchanging, pure —
this is the samaya of all minds,
and from now the knowledge of the Victors brings the knowing to its end.

The phenomena whose identity is inexpressible,
without name, form, intellect, or thing —
this is the samaya of all phenomena,
and therefore the all-pervading lord brings the lotus to its end.

The phenomena whose identity is non-conceptual
are things that are by nature at peace;
this is the samaya of all vajras,
and therefore the sovereign brings obstacles to their end.

Indestructible, utterly beyond knowing,
inexpressible and free of conceptuality —
this awakening wisdom of the buddhas:
knowing it, one attains bliss.

Using delusion through delusion, in order to exhaust delusion,
the Yamāntaka brings the body to its end
and thereby brings what is to be known to its end.

Using faults through faults, in order to exhaust faults,
the knowing brings the mind to its end

and thereby brings the afflictions to their end.

Using attachment through attachment, the lotus exhausts attachment,
and thereby brings clinging to its end,
and likewise brings meditative absorption to its end.

That which exhausts all afflictions,
and likewise exhausts all karma,
the wisdom that exhausts all obscurations —
this is explained as bringing obstacles to their end.

When the obscurations of the vajra of affliction are purified —

All actions are thoroughly purified,
and through the thorough purification of all actions,
the fruit born of action becomes thoroughly pure.

The apprehended object, attachment itself,
the aspect that is likewise immovable,
the cause itself and the fruit itself, purified —
from these six, mind arises completely.

The King of Desire and five others
are renowned as the Lord of the Wrathful Ones.
The samaya vajra and five others,
the ground and others in five aspects,
are known as arisen and as arisen from arising.
This is explained as the King of Vidyās.

The vajra of form and five others
are explained as the Lord of Vajras.

From the vajra of body, speech, and mind,
the Great Self arises completely.

The aggregates, elements, and sense sources — form
purified from skillful means and wisdom —
through the practice of the completion stage,
the mantra-practitioner having fixed the practice,
with conviction that all is pure,
having abandoned all fear,
with a mind free from hesitation,
the mantra-practitioner moves like a lion.

In this there is nothing whatsoever that must not be done,
likewise there is nothing whatsoever that must not be eaten,
there is nothing at all that must not be spoken,
there is nothing whatsoever that must never be contemplated.

Through practice not in meditative equipoise,
one settles into permanent equipoise.
That which moves through all minds
is explained as moving through all.

Whatever mind arises in dependence on the conditions
of the faculties and their objects —
that mind is explained as "man."
The syllable "tra" carries the meaning of protection.
What is explained as the samaya vow
through which one is fully liberated from worldly conduct,
protected by all vajras —
this is explained as mantra conduct.

Reflecting in the mind on the essential nature of each and every one,
through the categories of reciting the secret mantra,
one recites, emanates, and gathers.
The lord of the various buddha-vajras
gathers by means of the seeds of wisdom.
Through the seed of awakening and no-self,
one possessed of vows grasps no-self.
One emanates variously, as with variety,
and recites with the seeds of the three times.
Because recitation is renowned as speaking,
all speech is explained as recitation,
and all mantras are explained as invocations —
indeed, to urge that reality is to speak.

Just as mind and so forth bestow blessing,
so too does meditative absorption.
These confer empowerment upon the crown of the head
and likewise make offering throughout.

The practice united with the awareness of whoever holds the vajra,
the self-blessing and so forth, likewise —
these four are to be known as that one's enjoyments.

Upon the crown of the hero of the single vajra,
empowerment is conferred one by one:
the essence, mudrā, and mantra alone,
and the clan seal applied in sequence.

The fruit seals the cause,
and the cause seals the fruit.
Other than through meditation, accomplishment
will not arise even in ten million aeons.

The vajra-bearing person of awareness,
endowed with the four enjoyments,
through the divisions of body, speech, and mind,
meditates in a triangular form.

Meditate upon a wheel entirely yellow,
with ten spokes, within the center.
On every spoke, ten wrathful ones,
arising from ten wisdom-essences.

Meditate upon it with the vajra of cessation,
and accomplish it through supreme beauty.
Through the emanation of a cloud of blazing vajras,
it revolves like the Immovable One.

Thus the wisdom arisen from the dharmodaya (the source of phenomena),
by nature stainless and at peace —
through meditation, in a single instant,
the eye of the Buddha arises completely.

The Dharma taught by the Vajra-Bearer
rests correctly upon the two stages:
the stage of generation itself,
and likewise the stage of completion.

Practice, diligence,
samaya, and likewise the vows —
all of these were previously set forth in detail
through the distinctions of the stages.

Forms, sounds, and so forth — objects of desire —
partake of the nature of both pleasure and pain.
Attachment, aversion, delusion, and so forth

continually arise in the heart.

Toward attachment, the one who holds the vajra of desire —

like a vajra, the jewel arises;

like a jewel, one knows the samaya.

Those desiderata are equal to the samaya —

with form and likewise without form.

The all-pervading nature of the three syllables:

activity, and recitation,

sending forth and one's own repetition — these are to be performed.

In that same way, aversion and delusion

are to be generated upon the three grounds.

The Lord of Secrets seals them,

and accomplishes the purpose of the Vajra-Bearer.

The yogin who employs the yoga of aversion

generates the wheel of aversion;

then, having struck it with the fierce vajra,

the Wisdom-Vajra-Bearer draws it in.

Having comprehended it with enthusiasm,

in like manner it is sent forth and then drawn back in again.

If one familiarizes oneself with this practice,

aversion itself transforms into the vajra nature.

The three realms in their entirety —

destroying them and likewise healing them,

performing this in a mere instant —

without doubt one becomes capable of manifesting this directly.

The yogin who employs the yoga of delusion

generates the wheel of delusion;

then, whatever ornaments and such there may be,

all of those are perpetually to be taken.

Meditate upon the ocean of the mind of delusion,

filling it completely with all precious things.

All those who possess the wheel of delusion

shower down a rain of generosity.

All substances without exception

are to be offered and dispersed entirely.

By the firm vajra of the mind,
in a mere instant they are distributed.

The yogin who employs the yoga of attachment
generates the wheel of attachment;
then, having seized all the goddesses,
engages in desire through the practice of desire.
Reveling in the pleasure of joy and bliss,
one performs magical displays through the sport of desire.
Thereupon, to all who possess the wheel,
the goddesses are fully to be offered.
Even the wives of gods and demigods
born within the three realms —
if one enjoys desire in a mere instant,
what need is there to speak of human women?

The maṇḍala, the empowerment,
and the hosts of supreme activities —
receiving them and conferring blessing:
that is a different path of accomplishment.

What is known as the maṇḍala of the bhaga,
the maṇḍala of bodhicitta,
and what is taught as the maṇḍala of the body —
these three are declared to be the maṇḍalas.

The aggregates, sense bases, and elements
are all sealed by all the buddhas.
That which perpetually affixes the seal
is taught to be the maṇḍala.

The hook, the club, the trident,
and the sword are arrayed at the boundaries.
The hook of desire and the blue club — a power that does not waver —
the wheel above, beautiful, harmful below.
The wheel-turning seal of the six
who are vidyā-kings and vajra-bearers.
The bodhisattva mudrā of the grounds and so forth —
one's own maṇḍala.

The six mudrās arising from the dharmā-source:
the mirror, the vīṇā, the conch,
and likewise the vessel and various silks.
Vajrapāṇi, the lord of vajras,
buddhas, bodhisattvas,
and the kings of wrath perform the sealing.

Furthermore, a single hero —
the lineage is to be examined by its color.
Nine goddesses and the element of space:
these are explained as flowers.
Arranged in sequence by lineage
through the distinctions of body, speech, and mind.

The stūpa is declared to be the abode,
the dwelling-palace of all buddhas.
That which the wisdom-being touches
is called the wisdom wheel.

The unchanging vajra, the three syllables —
the seed syllable is called the abiding place.
The suchness of body, speech, and mind
is said to be aroused by awakening it.
Rays of light are sent forth
into the world-realms of the ten directions.

By all the Vajra-Bearers' invitation,
all the Vajra-Bearers are invited.

The rays of light from that abode of the Vajra-Bearer
gather all the vajras together;
in the manner of a ball they are bound —
this binding is declared to be the binding.
By the vajras of body, speech, and mind —
into the maṇḍala of body, speech, and mind,
body, speech, and mind are sealed.

The maṇḍala of images is to be examined.

The empowerment is divided into three kinds —
so examine this tantra thoroughly.

The first is the vase empowerment;
the second is the secret empowerment;

the third is the wisdom-gnosis empowerment;
the fourth is likewise the same.

With wide eyes, fit to be a vessel for mantra,
the flower has fallen and the seed syllable has arisen.
Taking it up, the secret empowerment
is given by the master of mantra to the disciples.

Abiding in the center of the expanse of space,
complete with fragrant water and foot-washing water,
through the union of vajra and lotus,
all Vajra-Bearers are fully gathered.
By the vajras of body, speech, and mind,
all of these are fully gathered into the heart.
Emerging from the path of the vajra,
they are to be caused to descend into the disciple's mouth.
This is the supreme rank of empowerment
among all the secret mantra empowerments.
The hosts of supreme activities
and all secret mantras will be accomplished.

One of supreme faith and great wisdom,
of handsome form, pleasing to the sādḥaka,
accustomed through practice to a single union,
possessing the samaya of the pure samayas —
such a disciple is to present offerings fully to the master,
and the master, blessing her,
shall give her to the sādḥaka.

One who is dull engages as the very nature of delusion,
is fully endowed with the joy of delusion.
When empowerment is conferred through the stream of delusion,
one becomes the very nature of the delusion-vajra.

One who is averse engages as the very nature of aversion,
is fully endowed with the joy of aversion.
When empowerment is conferred through the stream of aversion,
one becomes the very nature of the aversion-vajra.

One who is attached engages as the very nature of desire,
is fully endowed with the joy of desire.

When empowerment is conferred through the stream of desire,
one becomes the very nature of the desire-vajra.

One who engages as the very nature of wisdom and gnosis,
is fully endowed with vajra-joy.

When empowerment is conferred through the stream of gnosis,
one becomes the very nature of wisdom and gnosis.

That very knowledge-goddess (vidyā)
is to be received by the disciple of the Vajra-Bearer.
Placing hand upon hand,
one masters the Tathāgatas,
lays one's hand upon the disciple's head,
and the master, the Vajra-Bearer, imparts the charge.
By no other means can buddhahood be attained —
therefore this vidyā is supreme.

All phenomena being without duality,
things are designated as two.
Therefore you should never
pursue liberation from saṃsāra on your own.
This is the unsurpassed conduct of the vidyā of all buddhas.

If a fool transgresses this,
the supreme siddhi (Skt. siddhi) shall not arise for him.

In the phenomena of the ordinary body,
the five impurities appear —
yet blessed by the five wisdoms,
they are said to be the five nectars (Skt. amṛta).

Burning, likewise scorching,
illuminating, and the appearance of form —
by perfectly joining them in the mantra-body,
the five nectars are to be consumed.

What arises from the vajra, HŪṂ,
is to be contemplated as abiding in the mid-sky.
The lotus arisen from AḤ
is to be meditated upon below it.
The nectar marked by OM

is to be placed at its center.
The equal union of vajra and lotus,
blazing, is to satisfy the yogin.

It appears like crystal,
and has become a second sun of wisdom.
Drawn by the supreme weapon
from all the world-realms of the ten directions,
that nectar is caused to descend,
and is to be consumed through the practice of eating.

Through the ritual of the siddhi to be accomplished,
likewise the five heroes are to be consumed.
They are to be generated from the seeds of the three syllables —
otherwise that will not be accomplished.

Siddhis such as invisibility and the like
are said to be ordinary.
The accomplishment of buddhahood itself —
that, buddhas have declared the supreme siddhi.

The four modes of skillful means
have been taught by the Awakening-Vajra-Bearer (Vajrasattva).
In all the Yoga Tantras,
the yogin is ever to praise them.
The first is the ritual of approach;
the second is close approach;
the third is accomplishment;
and the fourth is great accomplishment.

By the distinction between ordinary and supreme,
approach becomes twofold in kind.
The four vajras are the ordinary;
the supreme is the nectar of primordial wisdom.

The first is emptiness and awakening;
the second is the gathering of seeds;
the third is the completion of form;
and the fourth is the placement of syllables.
By means of these four vajras,
approach is to be performed for ordinary accomplishment.

The supreme is the nectar of primordial wisdom itself.

Through the activity of the six applications,
and by means of the six limbs of approach,
the supreme accomplishment is attained.

Were one to strive otherwise,
the supreme siddhi will not arise.

Withdrawal, meditative concentration,
vital breath, likewise retention,
recollection, and meditative absorption —
these have been taught as the six limbs of application.

Among all the modes of entry and resting
of the ten senses in their respective domains,
the gathering of desire back to its individual source
is called withdrawal.

Having briefly gathered the five desires
and aligned them with the five buddhas,
the examination thus performed is called meditative concentration,
and that concentration arises in fivefold form:
applied thought and discursive investigation, joy,
likewise bliss itself,
and the one-pointedness of mind —
in these five, concentration is gathered.

Throughout all the secret tantras,
taught in many forms,
the arising of thought from the three secrets
is to be enjoyed.

The third is akin to joy;
the fourth is the gathering of bliss.
Know that the fifth is one's own mind,
wherein the knowing and the known have both arisen and ceased.
The actual pacification of all buddhas
abides fully in all desires.

The breath of the nature of the five wisdoms,
the essential nature of the five elements,
drawn out in the form of a sphere —

contemplate it thoroughly at the tip of the nose.

The five precious colors:

this is what is called vital breath and exertion.

Having visualized one's own mantra at the heart,

let the life-breath be settled, become a drop.

Autonomy is purity of the jewel;

apprehended and apprehender are said to be present.

The mind becomes the vajra of cessation;

from there the grasping at characteristics arises.

The domain of characteristics arises in fivefold form,

as taught by Awakening-Vajra (Vajrasattva).

The first is like a mirage;

the second is like smoke;

the third is like luminous space;

the fourth blazes like a lamp;

and the fifth is a continuous radiance

like a cloudless sky.

Having stabilized oneself through the vajra-path,

one is to expand into the element of space.

Whatever aspect of recollection one fully cultivates,

one is to expand so as to resemble that.

This is called recollection,

and individual appearances arise therein.

Through the equipoise of method and wisdom,

all phenomena gathered in brief,

contracted in the manner of a sphere,

one vividly cultivates form at the center.

Completing wisdom in an instant —

this abides in what is called meditative absorption.

When one enters equipoise in withdrawal,

all mantras are blessed.

When one enters equipoise in the wisdom of meditative concentration,

the five superknowledges are attained.

Through vital breath and exertion, assuredly,

bodhisattvas behold.

Through the power of constant retention,
Vajrasattva truly arises.

Through the application of recollection,
a maṇḍala of light comes forth.

Through meditative absorption, by mastery alone,
all obscurations are shed.

That essence is to be regarded at the heart
through the application of Moon-Vajra.

Drawn out by the supreme weapon,
the mind is made the substance of mantra,
and in the form and manner of mantra's body,
the awakening verse is to be recited.

Through correctly applying, practicing, and cultivating the ritual,
one abides in one's own maṇḍala.

That mind is then cultivated
through the form of primordial wisdom —
this is close accomplishment.

For as long as it is seen,
both aspects are to be cultivated for six months.

One should always enjoy every desire
and carry this out at all times.

If, after six months, what has been described
has not yet been seen,
the ritual and the vow as explained
should be undertaken three times over.

Even if the practitioner has done this
and the vision still has not arisen,
and the activity still has not been accomplished,
one should accomplish it through fierce application.
At that time, the wisdom of that deity
will certainly and swiftly come to be accomplished.

Through the application that distinguishes the family lineage,
one affixes the stake with the Vajra Stake (Skt. Vajrakīlaya).
Then one should also perform
the application for subjugation and the application for protection.

In the very manner of great passion,
one gathers in those who possess the wisdom wheel.

The nine goddesses are generated
and placed upon the body of the one to be accomplished.
From the complete transformation, the four mudrās
are to be examined within that maṇḍala.
Having established oneself at the center,
all those who possess the wheel are to be gathered in.

All are made the substance of vajra,
and below that one meditates on awakening.
Through the four invocation songs of rousing,
the goddess rouses the essence.
The mind, of vajra nature throughout the three times,
meditates on the body as like primordial wisdom.

Through pride one distinguishes colors.
That likewise is the essence of experience.
Through empowerment, one's own cause
is the fruit opened by the ground.
Through mantra, Dharma is enacted,
and awareness itself is the mudrā of Dharma.

The six wheel-turning kings
are renowned as the Uṣṇīṣa.
Through great miraculous power, the four enjoyments
are renowned as the Queen of Awareness.
Likewise, the lords of vajra
are described as All-Desires.
Empowerment conferred upon all Vajra Meditative Concentration
is supremely praised.

Through this application of ritual,
together with the body of primordial wisdom,
by the vajra of body, speech, and mind,
one accomplishes making these non-dual.

In accordance with the sequence explained before,
the vajra-being of awareness
generates the maṇḍala similar to oneself.

This is called great accomplishment.

During the time of close approach, the Great Uṣṇīṣa
is visualized in form through the application itself.

During the time of near-accomplishment,
within the form of the swirling nectar,
the mantra practitioner who knows the ritual
should carry out accomplishment through the application of one's own deity.

During the time of great accomplishment,
the form of the paramount sovereign, the buddha-lord —
this is the great secret of all vajra-holders
and of the supreme yogins.

Having understood these distinctions in this way,
one should accomplish the supreme attainment.
Otherwise, even over ten million aeons,
buddhas and protectors alike
will certainly not bring forth
the supreme attainment of peaceful qualities.

Whatever the activity and its concordant application
that the yogin visualizes,
having generated that maṇḍala accordingly,
one should meditate on the inexhaustible sacred bond (Skt. samaya).
The first sacred bond of the vajra of body, speech, and mind
is to be guarded.

Then the sacred bond of the Uṣṇīṣa
arises from the ritual as spoken.
In accordance with each concordant activity,
one should also give instructions to one's own retinue.
And with regard to whatever body is to be accomplished,
having fully meditated on the maṇḍala,
one should proclaim the fault of that being
at the wheel of that body's abode.
Then, having overcome those beings with that,
one meditates on what has arisen.
Having meditated through all things,
having drawn forth through all things —

one should insert it into one's own wheel.
With the substances as spoken in the ritual,
having made an image of that being,
with a mind pervaded by fierce wrath,
one should press down on the mark with one's foot.
Then the wrathful one, empowered by command,
surrounded by various retinues —
the practitioner endowed with the vajra
should send the object to be accomplished away in secret.
Surrounded by that king of wrathful ones,
that being is bound and struck,
and then, tormented and made to tremble,
the practitioner should summon it back.
With the mantras of the three vajras,
having caused them to descend upon that image,
the mantra-holder, with the pure vajras,
at the crown, throat, and heart —
should strike with the kīla and its mantra.
All plagues and every harm
arising from various places —
having caused those to descend upon that form,
one should strike them with the kīla.
Then with all the preparatory rites,
in accordance with the ritual as spoken,
the applications of the mechanical device and mantra, and so on,
should be applied according to the division of activity.
Having pressed upon the mark, one recites,
or performs a fire offering at the wrathful maṇḍala,
and through meditation one should carefully examine
that a harmful sentient being has been consumed.
For the peaceful rite, act with a peaceful mind.
For the enriching rite, act with a joyful mind.
For the rite of power, act with a desirous mind.
For the wrathful rite, accomplish it with fierce ferocity.

Then all those Blessed Ones, the Tathāgatas, having cut through all doubts of those great bodhisattvas, the great beings, and having resolved all their doubts, entered into the vajra of their own body, speech, and mind through

the vajra of body, speech, and mind; and, focusing through their own body, speech, and mind, they remained in silence, saying nothing at all.

Then all those great bodhisattvas, the great beings, praised all those Tathāgatas with this king of praises:

We bow to you, body of all.

We bow and prostrate to the speech of all.

We bow to you, mind of all.

We bow and prostrate to the action of all.

Because through vajra body, speech, and mind
the vajra body, speech, and mind are to be obtained,
sentient beings and buddhas are alike in being unequal alike.
Who is the object to be accomplished, and who is the accomplisher?

The great lord, the sovereign of accomplishment —
by slaying all buddhas,
how is one not tainted by sin?
And if one were tainted, what would the result be?

Then all those Tathāgatas said "Excellent! Excellent!" to those great bodhisattvas, the great beings, and declared:

Well done, well done, O great bodhisattva!
Well done, well done, O great self!
Well done, well done, O great melodious voice!
Well done, well done, O great offering!

O teacher, one who holds the awakening-vajra,
O glorious lord of all buddhas —
all phenomena, like illusions,
you cause to arise and to gather.
Therefore no sin accrues to that one.
Merit too is likewise absent.
Where there is neither sin nor merit,
that, it is said, is awakening.

By that protector's deception,
all embodied beings are destroyed,
yet they are not born in the lower destinies,
and awakening too is not difficult to find.

Since in times past, through unbearable deeds,
if beings should be born in the hells,
the great fruit of those hells
is vast indeed.

But this object accomplished by the awakening-vajra,
sealed with primordial wisdom,
by that application for the sake of sentient beings,
should be known as supremely beneficial.

Subduing and holding in one's custody —
all this is to be performed by that great self.
Having brought the great accomplishment to its culmination,
one should then undertake the activities.

Then all those great bodhisattvas, the great beings, having heard the Dharma
in the manner of the great compassion of all vajra-holders, were filled with joy
and great delight; and with a gratified mind they said "Excellent!" and offered:

Well done, well done, O great protector!
Well done, well done, O great sage!
Well done, well done, O great phenomena!

Well done, well done — great compassion!
How wondrous! Samantabhadra's
great compassion, unstained and pure —
even through unbearably fierce actions,
it bestows the very fruit of buddhahood.

Then all those Tathāgatas spoke these words to all those bodhisattvas, those
great beings:

"Sons of noble family, for this reason you should feel no fear, no dread, no
terror at the mantra of the empowerment that gathers the secret
empowerment conferred by all Tathāgatas. Why is that?"

Arisen from the vajra of awakening,
the great vajra of aversion, and the rest —
these streams of mantra, thus assembled,
are not to be wholly abandoned.

Then all those bodhisattvas, those great beings, praised all those Tathāgatas
with one voice in this verse:

That which is the mind-vajra of the three times, encompassing saṃsāra and liberation,
peaceful, unobscured, of the essential nature of pure space —
the fully blossomed buddha, lord of awakening, vajra-holder —
to that one we ever bow with body, speech, and mind.

That which is form, feeling, perception, formations,
consciousness, the six sense bases, the six sense faculties,
earth, water, fire, wind, and all of space —
to that vast expanse alike to awakening mind, we bow.

That which is delusion's fault, desire's vajra, the dharmas and all the rest,
arising from the union of awareness, ever supremely connected,
manifesting in various aspects, intoxicated with joy —
to that vast expanse alike to awakening mind, we bow.

That which is enthusiasm and joy, the aspects that do not change,
the dharmas that follow in mind according to the nature of cause and result,
bewilderment, aversion, and desire — obscurations become vajra —
to that vast expanse alike to awakening mind, we bow.

That which meditates on this beginningless, utterly pure reality,
arisen from skillful means and wisdom, free from conceptual elaboration,
examining the conduct, samaya, and union of the secret empowerment —
to that, seen as alike to the vajra of awakening, we ever bow.

That which meditates on this method, the supreme accomplishment,
the approach, the proximate practice, the accomplishment, and the great
accomplishment —
the master of attainment whose mind does not waver —
to that, seen as alike to the vajra of awakening, we ever bow.

That which accomplishes the vajras of the four sessions,
attaining the various supreme and lesser accomplishments such as invisibility
and more,
and through the grace of the guru has here understood the path without error —
to that, seen as alike to the vajra of awakening, we ever bow.

That which listens to this tantra, the most secret and gathered,
that recites it, reads it, and reflects upon it,
that makes offerings to it, inquires about it, or causes others to inquire —

to that, seen as alike to the vajra of awakening, we ever bow.

Wherever, through extremely careful examination of the collection of activities such as pacification and the rest,
one stamps with the ritual procedure of the mudrā and the mantra wheel,
the master of accomplishment endowed with these aims of practice —
to that, seen as alike to the vajra of awakening, we ever bow.

Whoever sees or makes contact with the chief practitioner,
remembers well, or merely hears the name with certainty,
generates faith, or holds even a single direction of it —
to that, seen as alike to the vajra of awakening, we ever bow.

With these peaceful words of praise,
praising all the guides,
and rejoicing in those protectors
for the great offering to the bodhisattvas —
what arose from the gathered secret,
the secret of all Tathāgatas:
this tantra was excellently spoken
by the supreme lord of all tantras.

Then all those Tathāgatas, and

all those bodhisattvas, having spoken thus, rested in the vajra of their own body, speech, and mind. Focusing on the vajra body, speech, and mind of body, speech, and mind vajra — on the vajra of their own body, speech, and mind — they became utterly silent.

This completes the eighteenth chapter, entitled "The Blessing of Vajra Wisdom That Reveals All Secrets," from the Great Secret of the Body, Speech, and Mind of All Tathāgatas: the Compendium of Secrets.

Translated and revised and definitively established by the Indian master, the ācārya Śraddhākaravarman, together with the great editor-translator, the monk Rinchen Zangpo.

Translator's Notes

- The passage is from the Guhyasamājantra, specifically its Uttaratantra (Subsequent Tantra), the seventeenth chapter. The colophon line at the opening attributes the editing and finalization of the text to "Dharma Lord Dpal," likely a Tibetan editorial figure associated with the transmission.

The verse exclamation "Ema'o" is a classical Tibetan interjection of wonder, retained in the translation as "Oh!" for natural spoken rendering; its Indic equivalent would be something like "āścaryam" (wonderful/astonishing).

The series of Sanskrit terms in transliteration — Vajradhṛk, Jinadhṛk, Ratnadhṛk, Ārolika, Prajñādhṛk, Yamāntakṛta, Prajñāntakṛta, Padmāntakṛta, Vighnāntakṛta — are technical deity and rite names from the Guhyasamāja system. They are preserved in their Sanskrit form since they are proper technical designations, not translatable common nouns. The Tibetan is here simply transliterating Sanskrit originals.

The line rendered "the stream of the lord of the wheel of existence continues" is genuinely ambiguous: "'khor bdag gi rgyun" could mean "the stream of the self of the lord of the wheel" (i.e., saṃsāra's own continuum) or could be an epithet-sequence. The translation follows the most natural grammatical reading.

- The enumeration of numbered categories in this passage (fifth, ninth, seventeenth, thirteenth, etc.) likely refers to chapters or sections of a root tantra, the precise identification of which would require collation with specific textual witnesses; the rendering preserves the numbers exactly as given. The phrase rendered "that which cannot be taken away" (mi 'phrog pa) in the context of the threefold tantra continuum could alternatively be rendered "the inviolable" or "the inalienable," referring to the resultant tantra; this is a technical distinction within tantra classification theory and the choice here follows the most natural reading in context.
- The passage contains several transliterated Sanskrit deity-function names rendered into Tibetan phonetic script: Vajradhrika, Ratnadhrika, Ārolika, and Prajñādhrika. These appear to represent holders or bearers associated with the vajra, jewel, lotus, and wisdom families respectively, functioning as functional titles within a tantric pentad schema. The Tibetan transliterations are approximate and the underlying Sanskrit forms may vary across manuscript traditions.

"Jinajik" renders འཇམ་འབྲུག་པོ་ལྷ་མོ་, which appears to contain a phonetically transcribed term (likely a tantric deity name) alongside the Tibetan "Victor born from birth." The precise Sanskrit original and identity of this figure are uncertain.

"Ārolika" and similar terms suggest a connection to the Chakrasaṃvara or related Cakra-tantra traditions where these are known epithets.

The phrase rendered "the all-pervading lord brings the lotus to its end" and "the sovereign brings obstacles to their end" represent འཇམ་འབྲུག་པོ་ (Vibhu/Īśvara-type epithet) and འཇམ་འབྲུག་པོ་ (chief/sovereign), likely referring to Amoghasiddhi- and Vairocana-family tantric lords in context.

- The passage is from a dense tantric text, likely the Vajramālā or a related anuttarayogatantra scripture. Several lists of six elements correspond to the six vajra-families or the six afflictions repurposed as paths; the translation follows the Tibetan syntax closely. The phrase rendered "arisen and as arisen from arising" reflects the compound structure of "byung dang byung las gyur" and its technical tantric sense of the arising of elements and their derivatives; this is a recognized doctrinal formula though its precise referent varies by commentary. The syllable analysis of "mantra" as "man" (mind) and "tra" (protection) is a standard Indic etymological gloss preserved faithfully here. The term "dharmodaya" (chos 'byung) is left in Sanskrit as it is a specific tantric technical term for the triangular source-of-phenomena symbol; a parenthetical gloss is given in the text as "source of phenomena."
- The term "bhaga" in "the maṇḍala of the bhaga" is a Sanskrit loanword used in tantric contexts to refer to the female generative principle or the sacred space associated with it; it is

intentionally left untranslated in keeping with tantric convention, as glossing it would be intrusive and potentially misleading in a doctrinal context.

The phrase rendered "harmful below, beautiful above" regarding the wheel involves some ambiguity; the Tibetan "ཁོ་གླིང་དཀར་པོ་སྐྱོན་ལོ།" could mean "below, the harmful beautiful one" or describe paired qualities of the wheel. The rendering adopted reflects the most natural reading in context.

The "three grounds" upon which aversion and delusion are generated likely refers to the three realms or three levels of existence, consistent with the usage of "sa gsum" throughout the tantra.

- The passage describes the inner secret empowerment sequence in a Yoga Tantra context. The "five nectars" and their generation from five afflictions transformed by the five wisdoms is standard highest-yoga/yoga-tantra soteriology; the text explicitly treats the three poisons plus wisdom-gnosis as bases for empowerment, a doctrine characteristic of the Vajrayāna. The line rendered "the four modes of skillful means taught by the Awakening-Vajra-Bearer" — the epithet འཇིགས་རྒྱུད་བཤེན་པོ་ — most naturally refers to Vajrasattva in his bodhicitta-vajra aspect, though it could in principle be read as a human Vajra-Master. The four-limbed sādhana sequence (approach, close approach, accomplishment, great accomplishment) is the standard catuṣpīṭha/yoga-tantra fourfold practice structure.
- The "six limbs of application" rendered here follow a well-attested Yoga Tantra schema broadly parallel to the six-limbed yoga of the Kālacakra tradition, though the terms here are specific to the Yoga Tantras. The limbs are: withdrawal (pratyāhāra), meditative concentration (dhyāna), vital breath (prāṇāyāma), retention (dhāraṇā), recollection (anusmṛti), and meditative absorption (samādhi).

"Moon-Vajra" in the penultimate section likely refers to Candravajra, a tantric deity or a tantric master, though in context it may function as an epithet or as the name of a specific practice-instruction. The meaning of the line is that the heart-drop is contemplated through a practice attributed to or named after this figure.

The five signs enumerated — mirage, smoke, luminous space, blazing lamp, cloudless sky — are the classical five signs of the arising of inner gnosis in Yoga Tantra and related traditions.

- The passage belongs to a Vajrayāna sādhanā text describing the four activities of close approach, near-accomplishment, accomplishment, and great accomplishment in sequential order. The phrase rendered "six wheel-turning kings renowned as the Uṣṇīṣa" is dense and compressed; in context these are likely the six buddhas or six family lords associated with the uṣṇīṣa deity, though the exact referent depends on the specific tantra cycle. The final two lines of the passage are syntactically incomplete, ending mid-construction, indicating a continuation into the next passage. The line "one's own cause is the fruit opened by the ground" reflects a tantric doctrinal formula in which the empowerment reveals the relationship between ground and fruition; this is retained as literally as readability allows.
- The verse "sentient beings and buddhas are alike in being unequal alike" renders a deliberately paradoxical phrase that plays on the non-duality of accomplisher and object accomplished; the Tibetan is intentionally gnomic and resists smooth paraphrase. The sense is that the conventional distinction between buddhas and sentient beings, between accomplisher and accomplished, collapses from the standpoint of vajra non-duality.

The passage on "slaying all buddhas" and the discussion of sin and merit that follows is a standard antinomian framing found in higher tantric literature, where ritual destruction performed with non-dual wisdom is held to generate neither sin nor merit, but awakening itself. The framing "by that protector's deception, all embodied beings are destroyed" refers to the

liberating deceit of the compassionate teacher who employs wrathful means to free beings, not literal destruction.

- The phrase rendered "invisibility and the rest" translates *mi snang la sogs*, referring to a category of *siddhi* (accomplishment), specifically the power of making oneself invisible, listed as representative of the range of such attainments. The doctrinal precision here is that "supreme and lesser accomplishments" renders *mchog dang dman*, the standard tantric distinction between the supreme *siddhi* of buddhahood and the common or lesser *siddhis*.

The line "even through unbearably fierce actions, it bestows the very fruit of buddhahood" is doctrinally significant: it affirms that even the transformation of the most wrathful karma can yield awakening, a hallmark of tantric soteriology.

The colophon-like closing couplet beginning "what arose from the gathered secret" functions as a text-seal, identifying the tantra's source and authority; its placement here before the final prose resumption is consistent with interstitial colophonic conventions in tantric literature.

- The phrase rendered "vajra of their own body, speech, and mind" involves a dense repetition in the Tibetan that is intentional and liturgically significant: the bodhisattvas are said to abide in the vajra-nature, and then to focus on that same vajra-nature — the repetition enacts the meditative collapse of subject and object into the vajra of body, speech, and mind. The translation preserves this structural repetition as faithfully as readable English allows.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.